

Chris and Matt: A Proposal for Working Together

For Matt Campbell, from Chris Habetler. September 29, 2026.

Matt,

First, thank you for asking. I've loved working with you these last few months, and I really appreciate the trust behind it.

On the 22nd you asked what I could do, what it would look like, and what I would charge, so I took a stab at it. Read it as a starting point. I'm looking forward to talking it through and figuring out the best path together, and I expect we'll change a good bit of it.

What This Is For

- A clear working arrangement for the two of us. We've both said we want to work together, and I want the terms to match that.
- Helping you build EdTech Expertz into the empire you've talked about.
- The just-right level of support for this moment.
- Adjusting it as we go, so it grows when the business does.

I want to earn my place on your team, and I want you to feel completely comfortable asking me for whatever you need.

The Objective

The objective is to grow EdTech Expertz, in revenue and in impact. Right now the constraint is your time. You're uniquely qualified to do this work, your time is at a premium, and the business is ready to grow, but nobody has a time machine. What helps is the just-right level and type of support, from someone you know, who can add real value right away. That's what lets EdTech Expertz take on one or more additional clients, and it's a first step.

Everything from here on is a proposal. To be honest, I'm a little nervous putting numbers on paper, because I don't want to get this wrong in either direction, so forgive me in advance if anything here seems presumptuous. The only goal is an arrangement that works well for both of us, and it only works well for me if it works well for you.

How I'd Work

Operating Mindset

I'm in this with you. If it helps EdTech Expertz grow, send it my way, including things neither of us has thought of yet. When you need me, I'm available, with same-day replies and a 48-hour default on requests. Bedtimes and family time are harder, but we'll make it work. This is a startup, and that's part of the deal.

Approximate Time Commitment

About a day a week to start, more in heavy weeks and less in light ones. It's here so you know what's reasonable to ask for, not to draw a line. If it runs well past that for a month or two, we look at the base rate together.

Scope

What I've Heard You Need

- Research: crosswalks, diligence readouts, prep briefs on prospective clients, and people maps, whenever you need them.
- The referral network: running it day to day, from finding and onboarding members to the monthly meeting, a weekly digest so you can say yes or no in one pass, and the tracker in your Drive. Members can still come straight to you, and your clients still go through you to reach the network.
- The school-side voice in client work: sessions like Forward Edge on 10/1, messaging and language work, and feedback on decks and pitches.
- Introductions in both directions.

For the first month, my priorities would be prep briefs on your five parked leads, the member list cleaned up, a one-page card on each company, and the first weekly digest.

High Value, Worth Considering

- Team workspace: building out the EdTech Expertz ChatGPT workspace and projects, so each client's context and our research process are set up once and reused.
- Company knowledge base: keeping an internal wiki current in Google Drive and the ChatGPT workspace.
- First meetings: joining first meetings with prospective clients to give the school-side read on their product.
- Promotional materials: one-pagers, decks, leave-behinds, and other design work.
- Outreach: reaching the mid-size publishers and platforms on your target list.

Further Out

Representing EdTech Expertz at conferences, working with client teams on how they serve schools, school-leader feedback panels, sales training on how schools buy, procurement help, and AI enablement or L&D. When a client pays for any of this, we agree on my share before it starts.

Ownership

As with any subcontract, anything I create while working with you is yours, prompts included. The one exception is work I do directly for ClassE, which falls under my own agreement with Joe.

Proposed Base Rate

\$3,000 a month, starting October 1 or the day AAP signs, whichever is later. The work starts when the base rate does. Benchmark and Forward Edge on 10/1 are on me either way.

Here's how I got there, since you've been open with me about your numbers. Once AAP signs, you're supporting four clients, plus the network, plus what it takes to run the company. I don't know your exact revenue, so I used ClassE as a yardstick: four clients at about \$8,500 a month is around \$34,000 a month. About 10% of that is \$3,400, and I rounded down to \$3,000. New clients come in at 15%, since that's the growth this is meant to make room for. If I've got your numbers wrong, or this feels like an overreach, tell me and we'll rein it in.

How It Grows

- New clients: the base rate goes up by 15% of the monthly retainer for each new client EdTech Expertz signs after we start. A new client at \$10,000 a month adds \$1,500, bringing it to \$4,500. When a new retainer signs, tell me the monthly amount and I'll invoice the new number.
- The network: 20% of what EdTech Expertz keeps on deals that come through the referral network. That's the "grows as the sales these individuals bring in grows" piece you described on 9/16. I'll never pitch members, and my own intros stay under our August agreement.
- Projects, courses, and speaking: if I help build one, we agree on my share before it starts.
- Big changes: a very large client, a client leaving, or AAP slipping past October go to our next check-in, not to a formula.

This is the proposal. If it's too big a swing to start, let's find a smaller one. From what I understand, you could use the support, and I sure wouldn't mind a little income.

Checking In

This is meant to be ongoing, not a trial. The weekly check-in, where you set the priorities, handles week to week. In January we'd have our first real sit-down to look at what I delivered, what it freed up for you, and whether the base rate and the time still match the work. After that, we check in every quarter, or anytime either of us wants to.

Either of us can end it with 30 days' notice. The notice month is paid, and you'd get a clean handoff. The network share keeps paying for 12 months on deals already logged.

Items for Conversation

1. A full-time role. I'm in late rounds for a full-time role at a charter network, and there may be others. If one happens, you'll hear it from me first, and I want to keep doing both. The work would move to before and after the school day. What we'd work out together is timing (the network check-ins are the piece most tied to the school day) and anything a school employer would want to clear, since the network puts vendors in front of schools.
2. What you usually keep on a network deal. That number tells us whether 20% is right.
3. How many hours a week research and the network take you now.
4. The ClassE advisory. You asked on 9/16 what I'd need. Joe would pay this directly, so it doesn't touch your ClassE fee or count toward my 15%. My starting thought is \$3,000 a month, and I'd want your read on how to frame it with Joe and where that work ends and my work for you begins.
5. Which of the high-value ideas, if any, you'd want to start with.

Thank you again for asking me. Obviously there's a lot here, and I'm really looking forward to talking it through and figuring out what works best for you. Clarity is king, so push on any of it.

Chris